

HEALING FOR THE HOMES SERIES

LORD, ANXIETY IS HOLDING ME

Cast all your anxiety
on Him because
He cares for you.

— 1 PETER 5:7



Overcomers
Global Network

EDUCATE . EQUIP . EVOLVE

BY PROPHET JOSHUA MATTHEWS

DEDICATION

This booklet is dedicated to every person whose mind will not be still — the one who lies awake with a racing heart, the one who fears the worst before it happens, the one whose body carries the weight of worries that have not yet come to pass. You are not crazy. You are not weak. You are human, and God sees your struggle. He is about to speak peace into your storm.

A MESSAGE FROM THE FOUNDER

Dear friend,

Anxiety is one of the most misunderstood battles in the body of Christ. Too many believers have been told to "just have faith" or "stop worrying" — as if a single sentence could undo years of mental torment. That is not pastoral care. That is dismissal. And God does not dismiss you.

I have experienced anxiety in my own life — seasons where my mind would race with fears about the ministry, about my family, about things that hadn't even happened yet. And I learned something powerful during those seasons: anxiety is not a sin. It is a signal. It is your mind and body telling you that something needs attention — and God wants to be the One who gives that attention.

This booklet is not a replacement for professional help — if you need a doctor or counselor, please seek one. But it is a Word from heaven for your spirit, and I believe it will bring you peace that the world cannot give.

With all my love in Christ,

Joshua Matthews

Founder, Overcomers Global Network

The Cry of the Soul

It starts before you even open your eyes. Before the alarm goes off, before your feet touch the floor, the wave hits — a rush of dread that floods your chest and tells you something is wrong. You don't always know what. Sometimes there is nothing specific to point to. But your body is already in crisis mode, your heart is pounding, your breathing is shallow, and your mind is listing every possible thing that could go wrong today.

You get out of bed, but you are not rested. You slept, but your mind never stopped running. It was processing, planning, worrying, replaying — looping through scenarios that may never happen but feel absolutely certain in the dark hours of the night.

You put on a smile for your family. You go through your day. But underneath, there is a hum of tension that never fully goes away — like a radio stuck on a frequency you cannot turn off. Your shoulders are tight. Your stomach is unsettled. Your patience is thin. And when someone asks, "How are you?" you say "Fine" because how do you explain a war that is happening entirely inside your own head?

You have tried praying. You have tried worship. You have tried quoting Scripture. And sometimes it helps — for a moment. But the anxiety comes back. Again and again. And the worst part is the guilt: *"If I really trusted God, I wouldn't feel this way. What's wrong with my faith?"*

Nothing is wrong with your faith. Let me say that again so it reaches the place where you need it most: **nothing is wrong with your faith.** Anxiety is not a faith failure. It is a real condition with real causes — and God has real answers.

What the Bible Says

The most repeated command in the Bible is not "obey Me" or "worship Me." It is *"Do not be afraid."* It appears over 365 times — one for every day of the year. God did not repeat it because He was annoyed with fearful people. He repeated it because He *knew* fear and anxiety would be a constant battle for His children, and He wanted His reassurance to meet you every single day.

""Be anxious for nothing, but in everything by prayer and supplication, with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God; and the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus.""

— **Philippians 4:6–7 (NKJV)**

This passage is often quoted to anxious people in a way that feels like a reprimand: "See? The Bible says be anxious for nothing. Just stop worrying." But that is a misreading. Paul is not shaming you for feeling anxiety. He is giving you the *antidote*.

Notice the prescription: prayer, supplication (specific request), and *thanksgiving*. Thanksgiving is the part most people skip — and it is the key. When you begin thanking God in the middle of your anxiety, you are telling your brain and your spirit: "God is still good. God is still in control. I have evidence of His faithfulness." Gratitude redirects the mind from fear to faith.

And notice the result: peace that *surpasses understanding*. That means it does not make logical sense. Your circumstances may not change, but your internal state does. Peace shows up in a situation where peace has no business being — and that is the supernatural mark of God.

""You will keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on You, because he trusts in You.""

— **Isaiah 26:3 (NKJV)**

Jesus directly addressed anxiety in the Sermon on the Mount, and His approach was remarkably tender:

""Therefore I say to you, do not worry about your life, what you will eat or what you will drink; nor about your body, what you will put on. Is not life more than food and the body more than clothing? Look at the birds of the air, for they neither sow nor reap nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not of more value than they?""

— **Matthew 6:25–26 (NKJV)**

Jesus did not say, "Stop being weak." He said, "Look at the birds." He used a picture from nature — something simple, observable, beautiful — to remind you that the God who feeds creatures that cannot even plant a seed will certainly take care of you. If He tracks every sparrow, He is tracking your situation. If He clothes the lilies in glory, He will cover your needs.

And then He said something that every anxious person needs to tattoo on their heart:

""Which of you by worrying can add one cubit to his stature?""

— **Matthew 6:27 (NKJV)**

In other words: has worry ever solved a single problem? Has staying up all night with a racing mind ever added one day to your life, one dollar to your bank account, one solution to your crisis? Anxiety promises to protect you by preparing you for the worst, but it delivers nothing except exhaustion and dread.

This is not to shame you for worrying. It is to free you from the illusion that worrying is productive. It is not. And when you release the need to control the future, you create space for the One who actually controls it to work.

The Root of the Pain

Anxiety is not just a spiritual issue. It is a whole-person condition that affects the mind, the body, and the spirit. To bring healing, we need to understand all three dimensions.

The Brain Science of Anxiety. When you perceive a threat — real or imagined — your brain's amygdala sends an alarm signal that triggers the release of stress hormones, primarily cortisol and adrenaline. These hormones increase your heart rate, tighten your muscles, sharpen your senses, and prepare your body to fight or run.

This system was designed by God to protect you in genuinely dangerous situations. The problem is that in the modern world, the brain often cannot distinguish between a real threat (a car speeding toward you) and a perceived threat (a worry about tomorrow's bills). The alarm sounds the same, the hormones flood the same, and your body enters crisis mode for something that has not happened and may never happen.

When this system stays activated for long periods — chronic anxiety — the effects are devastating: insomnia, digestive disorders, headaches, muscle pain, weakened immune function, difficulty concentrating, irritability, and emotional numbness. This is not a character flaw. It is a physiological response, and it is important that you understand that God is not disappointed in your body for doing what it was designed to do.

Trauma-Based Anxiety. For many people, anxiety is rooted in past trauma — experiences that taught the brain that the world is unsafe. Childhood neglect, abuse, abandonment, sudden loss, violence, or growing up in a chaotic home can wire the brain for hypervigilance — a constant state of watching for danger.

""He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.""

— **Psalm 147:3 (NKJV)**

Spiritual Roots. While anxiety has real neurological and psychological components, it also has a spiritual dimension. The enemy uses fear as a weapon — not because he has real power over you, but because if he can keep you in a state of fear, you cannot operate in faith. Fear and faith cannot occupy the same space. They are opposing forces. And the enemy knows that a believer walking in faith is the most dangerous threat to his kingdom.

""For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this age, against spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places.""

— Ephesians 6:12 (NKJV)

Some of the anxious thoughts you are having are not yours. They are fiery darts from the enemy — intrusive, fear-based thoughts designed to destabilize you. And the Bible gives you a specific weapon for them:

""Above all, taking the shield of faith with which you will be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked one.""

— Ephesians 6:16 (NKJV)

The shield of faith does not prevent the darts from being thrown. It catches them before they penetrate. This means you can acknowledge an anxious thought without accepting it. You can say, "I hear that thought, but I do not receive it. My God is in control, and His Word says He has not given me a spirit of fear."

The Need for Control. At its core, anxiety is often the fear of losing control. We want to manage every outcome, plan for every scenario, prevent every possible disaster. But the truth is: you were never in control. God is. And the invitation of faith is to release the illusion of control and rest in the reality of His sovereignty.

""Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He shall direct your paths.""

— Proverbs 3:5–6 (NKJV)

Christ's Healing Power

There is a scene in the Gospels that is your scene — the storm on the Sea of Galilee:

""And a great windstorm arose, and the waves beat into the boat, so that it was already filling. But He was in the stern, asleep on a pillow. And they awoke Him and said to Him, 'Teacher, do You not care that we are perishing?' Then He arose and rebuked the wind, and said to the sea, 'Peace, be still!' And the wind ceased and there was a great calm.""

— Mark 4:37–39 (NKJV)

Everything about this story matters. The storm was real. The danger was real. The fear was real. And Jesus was *asleep*. Not worried. Not pacing. Asleep. Because He knew something the disciples had not yet learned: the storm had no authority over the boat because the Master was in it.

You are in a storm. The waves are high. The wind is loud. But Jesus is in your boat. He has not fallen overboard. He has not abandoned ship. And when the time is right — when your faith calls out to Him — He will stand up and say two words that every anxious heart needs to hear: **"Peace, be still."**

He is saying those words to you right now. To your racing thoughts: peace, be still. To your pounding heart: peace, be still. To the scenarios playing on repeat in your mind: peace, be still. To the dread that greets you every morning: peace, be still.

Receive it. Not as a theological concept. As a real, present, supernatural act of God in your life right now.

""Peace I leave with you, My peace I give to you; not as the world gives do I give to you. Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid.""

— John 14:27 (NKJV)

Healing Prayers

A Prayer for Peace of Mind

Father God, I bring my anxious mind to You. Every racing thought, every worst-case scenario, every fear that has taken up residence in my head — I lay it all at the foot of the cross. Your Word says to cast all my cares upon

You, for You care for me (1 Peter 5:7). I am casting them now, Lord. I refuse to pick them back up. Replace the anxiety with Your peace. Let the peace that surpasses all understanding guard my heart and my mind. I receive it now. In Jesus' name, amen.

A Prayer for Healing of the Nervous System

Lord Jesus, You made my body — every nerve, every synapse, every chemical process. You understand what is happening inside me better than any doctor. I ask You to touch my nervous system right now. Calm the adrenaline. Lower the cortisol. Reset the alarm that has been ringing nonstop. Heal me from the inside out — not just my spirit, but my physical body. You are Jehovah Rapha, the Lord who heals. Heal me now. In Your mighty name, amen.

A Prayer for Sleep

Father, I have not slept peacefully in a long time. My nights are filled with worry and my mornings with dread. But Your Word says You give Your beloved sleep (Psalm 127:2). I claim that promise tonight. I ask You to quiet my mind as I lie down. Guard my thoughts while I sleep. Let me wake refreshed and at peace. Thank You for being my watchman through the night. In Jesus' name, amen.

Prophetic Declarations

"Anxiety does not define me. I am defined by the peace of Christ."

"My mind is being renewed. My thoughts are coming under the authority of God's Word."

"I will not live in fear of tomorrow. My future is in God's hands."

"The storm in my mind is being silenced. Peace, be still."

"I cast every care on the Lord, and He sustains me."

**"God has not given me a spirit of fear — He has given me power, love,
and a sound mind."**

"I will sleep in peace and wake in hope."

"My body is being healed from the effects of chronic stress."

"I release the need to control the future. God is sovereign."

"The peace of God is guarding my heart and mind right now."

Reflection & Healing

Reflect on These Questions

1. What triggers your anxiety most? Finances? Health? Relationships? The future? Name it specifically.
2. When did your anxiety begin? Was there a specific event or season that started it?
3. What does your body feel like when anxiety hits? (Chest tightness, racing heart, stomach pain, shortness of breath?) Recognizing the physical signals helps you respond earlier.
4. What lies does anxiety tell you? Write them down — then write God's truth next to each one.
5. Have you sought help from a counselor or doctor? If not, what is holding you back?
6. What is one thing you can do today to create peace in your environment — even if it's small?

Beloved, the storm is not the end of your story. The same God who calmed the sea is calming your soul right now. Let Him. Breathe. Rest. He's got you.

A CLOSING PRAYER

Father God, I come to You on behalf of this reader whose mind has been a battlefield. In the name of Jesus Christ, I speak peace — shalom — over their thoughts, their emotions, their nervous system, and their spirit.

Lord, command the storm in their mind to be still, just as You commanded the storm on the sea. Let the waves of anxiety fall flat. Let the wind of fear die down. Let there be calm.

I decree that they will sleep in peace tonight. I decree that they will wake without dread tomorrow. I decree that the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard their heart and mind in Christ Jesus. It is done. In Jesus' name, amen.

AN INVITATION TO CHRIST

If you have never surrendered your life to Jesus Christ, He is reaching out to you right now. He is the Prince of Peace, and He wants to give you the peace your soul is desperate for. Pray: "Lord Jesus, I need You. I cannot carry this anxiety alone. I believe You died for me and rose again. I give You my life — my mind, my fears, my future. Be my Savior and my peace. Fill me with Your Spirit. I receive You now. In Jesus' name, amen."

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Anxiety can weigh on the mind, body, and spirit. This booklet offers biblical comfort, practical understanding, and healing prayer for the reader whose thoughts will not be still. Joshua Matthews reminds the anxious heart that God does not dismiss your struggle and that His peace is able to meet you even in the middle of the storm.

Let the peace of God speak
to your mind again.



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